📖 SIMPLIFIED WORKBOOK · SCAFFOLDED VERSION

SWIM & WATER SAFETY

Health & Physical Education · Year 7–8 · Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0

This workbook has **sentence starters**, **word banks**, and **circle choices** to help you. You don't need to write long answers — short, clear answers are great!

MY NAME _____

CLASS _____

TEACHER _____

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📌 **How This Workbook Helps You**

- **Word banks** give you words to choose from — you don't have to think of them yourself
- **Sentence starters** begin the answer for you — just finish the sentence
- **Circle choices** let you circle the right answer instead of writing
- There are no trick questions — your teacher wants to know what YOU think

1 Why Water Safety Matters in Victoria

📋 **KEY FACTS — REMEMBER THESE!**

💧 **52 people** drowned in Victoria in 2024–25. That is a LOT of people.

👦 **1 in 5** people who drowned were aged 15–24 years old — the same age as you in a few years.

🚫 **ZERO deaths** happened at patrolled beaches or supervised pools. Every single death happened somewhere without a lifeguard.

👨 Males are **4 times** more likely to drown than females.

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🏞️ Most drownings happen at **rivers, dams and lakes** — not at the beach.

Activity 1.1 — About Me and Water

~5 min

Circle your answers:

My favourite water place is:

The beach 🏖️ | A river or lake 🏞️ | A public pool 🏊 | A backyard pool 🏠 | I don't like swimming

How good a swimmer am I?

Still learning | Can swim a little | Good swimmer | Very strong swimmer

Activity 1.2 — Looking at the Data

~10 min

Look at the facts box above. Answer these questions using the word bank to help you.

WORD BANK

patrolled | unpatrolled | lifeguard | 54 | rivers | dangerous | 15–24 | males

Question 1 — 1 mark

How many people drowned in Victoria in 2024–25?

The answer is: _____

Question 2 1 mark

Where did ALL of the drowning deaths happen? Circle the right answer:

At patrolled beaches | At unpatrolled locations | At public pools | At school

Question 3 2 marks

Finish these sentences using words from the word bank:

Most drowning deaths happen at _____ locations because there is no _____ watching.

The most dangerous age group is _____ year olds.

Question 4 2 marks

Why do you think young people are more likely to drown than older adults? Use the word bank. Write **two ideas**:

IDEA BANK

peer pressure | showing off | risky dares | overconfident | no lifeguard | unpatrolled beach

Idea 1: Young people might drown because _____

Idea 2: Another reason is _____

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2 Beach Flags and Rip Currents

📋 KEY FACTS — BEACH FLAGS

🔴🟡 **Red and Yellow flags** = ALWAYS swim here. A lifeguard is watching you.

🔴 **Single red flag** = Dangerous. Only very experienced swimmers should enter.

⬛⬜ **Black and white squares** = For surfboards only. Swimmers must stay out.

🟡⚫ **Yellow with black ball** = Swimmers only. No surfboards.

🟠 **Orange windsock** = Offshore winds. NO inflatable toys — they will blow out to sea.

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🟣 **Purple flag** = Dangerous sea creatures (e.g. jellyfish). Be careful.

Activity 2.1 — Name the Flags ★ COLOUR

~8 min

Look at the flags. Write the name of each flag using the word bank below.

FLAG NAME BANK

Red & Yellow | **Single Red** | **Black & White** | **Yellow + Black Ball** | **Orange Windsock** | **Purple**



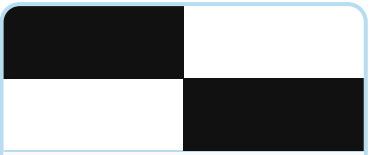
Flag 1: _____

I swim here: Yes / No (circle)



Flag 2: _____

I swim here: Yes / No (circle)



Flag 3: _____

Swimmers: Yes / No (circle)



Flag 4: _____

Surfboards: Yes / No (circle)



Flag 5: _____

Inflatables: Yes / No (circle)



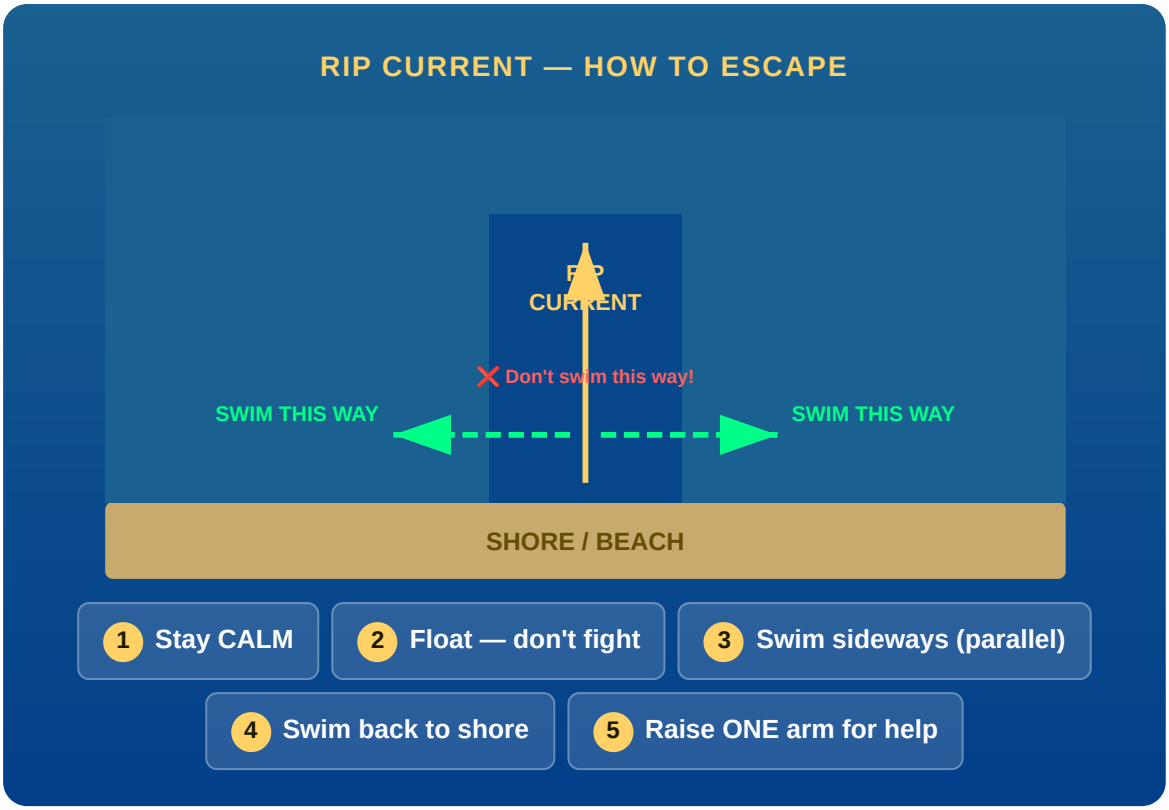
Flag 6: _____

Warning about: _____

Activity 2.2 — Rip Currents ★ COLOUR

~10 min

A **rip current** is fast-moving water that pulls you away from the beach. Look at the diagram carefully.



Question 2.2a `2 marks`

Look at the diagram. Circle the RIGHT answer:

If caught in a rip, you should swim:

- Directly back to shore (fight the current)
- Sideways along the shore (parallel)
- Straight out to sea

Question 2.2b 2 marks

Write the 5 rip escape steps. Use the steps shown above the diagram:

STEPS WORD BANK

Stay calm | Float | Swim sideways | Swim back | Raise one arm

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Step 4: _____

Step 5: _____

STORY

Liam went to a beach that had no flags. He felt water pulling him away from shore. He panicked and tried to swim back. He got very tired.

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Question 2.2c 2 marks

What were TWO mistakes Liam made? Circle your answers:

- He swam at a beach with no flags (unpatrolled)
- He wore a hat
- He tried to swim against the rip (used up all his energy)
- He had a friend with him

What should he have done instead? He should have

_____

3 Emergency Response — DRS ABCD

📋 DRS ABCD — WHAT TO DO IN AN EMERGENCY

🔍 **D = Danger** — Check for danger FIRST. Is it safe for YOU to go near?

👋 **R = Response** — Tap their shoulder and call their name loudly.

📞 **S = Send for help** — Call **000** (or tell someone else to call).

👄 **A = Airway** — Tilt their head back gently to open their airway.

👂 **B = Breathing** — Look, listen and feel — are they breathing?

💓 **C = CPR** — 30 chest pushes, then 2 breaths. Keep going until help arrives.

⚡ **D = Defibrillation** — Use the AED machine if one is nearby. It tells you exactly what to do.

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⚠️ **THROW, DON'T GO — The Most Important Rule!**

If someone is drowning, **DO NOT jump in** unless you are trained. You might drown too! Instead: throw them a rope, towel, pool noodle, or anything that floats. **Call 000 first.**

Activity 3.1 — DRS ABCD Practice

~5 min

Fill in the missing word for each letter. Use the word bank.

WORD BANK

Danger · Response · Send (000) · Airway · Breathing · CPR · Defibrillation

Letter	Word	What you do
D	_____	Check it is safe before going near
R	_____	Tap shoulder and call their name
S	_____	Call 000 immediately
A	_____	Tilt head back to open airway
B	_____	Look/listen/feel — are they breathing?
C	_____	30 chest pushes + 2 breaths
D	_____	Use the AED machine if available

Activity 3.2 — What Do You Do?

Pairs · ~8 min

STORY

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You are at a pool party. You look over and see someone floating face-down in the water. They are not moving. You have your phone. There is a rope near the pool edge.

Question 3.2a `1 mark`

What is the VERY FIRST thing you do?

- Jump in to help
- Check for danger first
- Run away
- Start CPR immediately

Question 3.2b `1 mark`

What number do you call?

I call: _____

Question 3.2c `2 marks`

Write what you would say to the person who answers the phone. Use this starter:

> **Hello, I need an ambulance. I am at _____. Someone has _____. They are / are not (circle one) breathing.**

4 Making Safe Decisions Near Water

📋 THE 5 LSV SWIMSAFE RULES

🪧 **Read signs** — Always check flags and warning signs before going in the water.

🦶 **Enter feet first** — Never dive head-first into water you don't know. There might be rocks underneath.

📏 **Stay in depth** — Only swim in water where your feet can touch the bottom (unless you're a strong swimmer).

👫 **Swim with a friend** — NEVER swim alone. If you get in trouble, no-one will know.

🙋 **Signal for help** — Raise ONE arm above your head if you need help.

Activity 4.0 — Spot the Hazards

Pairs · ~10 min

For each water place, write TWO dangers. Use the hazard bank below.

HAZARD BANK

rip current | no lifeguard | cold water | hidden rocks | strong river current | diving into shallow water | no fencing | submerged logs

Water Place	Danger 1	Danger 2
🏖 Unpatrolled beach		
🏞 River or dam		
🏊 Backyard pool		

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Question 4.0a 1 mark

Which place is MOST dangerous? Circle one and explain why:

Unpatrolled beach | River or dam | Backyard pool

I chose this because _____

Activity 4.1 — Safe or Not Safe? ~8 min

For each situation, circle **SAFE** or **NOT SAFE**. Then write what you should do instead.

Situation	Safe?	Better choice:
Swimming at a beach with red and yellow flags	**SAFE / NOT SAFE**	*This is already safe!*
Swimming at a river after heavy rain	**SAFE / NOT SAFE**	
Using an inflatable lilo when the orange windsock is up	**SAFE / NOT SAFE**	
Going for a swim by yourself in a dam	**SAFE / NOT SAFE**	

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Question 4.1a `2 marks`

Your friend says "Let's jump in this river — it looks fine!" What could you say? Use this starter:

> **I would say: "I don't think that's safe because _____. Let's go to _____ instead."**

5 Rivers, Dams and Cold Water

📋 COLD WATER FACTS

🌡️ Victorian lakes and rivers can be **very cold** even in summer — sometimes as cold as 12°C!

😮 Cold water makes your body **gasp** — you might accidentally breathe in water.

💪 Cold water quickly makes your muscles **stop working properly** — even strong swimmers can get into trouble.

✅ The safe way to enter cold water: go in slowly, one step at a time. Never jump straight in.

Activity 5.1 — Cold Water and Throw Rescue

~12 min

Question 5.1a

2 marks

What are TWO things cold water does to your body? Circle your answers:

- Makes you gasp (breathe in suddenly)
- Makes you swim faster
- Makes your muscles stop working
- Makes you feel more awake and alert

Question 5.1b

1 mark

What is the safest way to enter cold water? Circle the right answer:

- Jump straight in from a height
- Go in slowly, step by step
- Run and dive in headfirst

Throw Rescue — Rank the tools from BEST (1) to WORST (5):

Remember: **Throw, Don't Go** — never jump in if you're not trained!

Tool	My rank (1=best)
Rope with a floating end	
Life ring attached to the jetty	
Jumping in to help them swim	

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Tool	My rank (1=best)
Throwing a pool noodle	
Holding out a towel from the edge	

Activity 5.2 — Diving and Spinal Injury: What You Need to Know

~10 min

⚠ Important Facts About Diving

- Unsafe diving causes **10%** of all spinal cord injuries in Australia
- The most common victims are **males aged 10–14** — that could be someone you know
- **Two-thirds** of people injured this way are permanently disabled — often unable to move their arms or legs
- A sandbank can form overnight — a place that was safe last week might not be safe today
- **The rule: Feet First, First Time, Every Time** — always go in feet-first before diving anywhere

Three Real Stories — What Happened and Why

Story 1 — Terrigal Wharf, NSW (2025): A teenage boy dived from a wharf and hit the shallow water below. He didn't know how shallow it was. He needed a helicopter to hospital.

Story 2 — Torquay Beach, VIC (2025): A teenage boy dived at a surf beach and seriously injured his spine. A sandbank had shifted and the water was much shallower than he expected.

Story 3 — Bawley Beach, NSW (2024): A young man dived from a jetty he had jumped from before — safely. But a sandbank had formed since his last visit. He was seriously hurt.

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Question 5.2a 1 mark

Circle the correct answer: The safest way to enter unknown water is to…

- Dive in head-first so you can see the bottom
- Go in feet-first every single time ✓
- Ask someone if it looks deep enough
- Jump from as high as possible

Question 5.2b 2 marks

In Story 3, the young man had jumped from the same jetty safely before. Why was it still dangerous this time?

Question 5.2c 2 marks

Your friend says: *"That river is fine to dive into — we've done it heaps of times."* What would you say back to keep them safe?

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6 My Water Safety Plan

Activity 6.1 — My Safety Rules

~10 min

Write down the 5 SwimSafe rules from memory (look back at Section 4 if you need to):

SWIMSAFE RULES BANK

Read signs | Enter feet first | Stay in depth | Swim with a friend | Signal for help

Rule 1: _____

Rule 2: _____

Rule 3: _____

Rule 4: _____

Rule 5: _____

Question 6.1a — 1 mark

Which rule is MOST important for you? Circle one and explain:

Read signs | Enter feet first | Stay in depth | Swim with a friend | Signal for help

I chose this rule because _____

Activity 6.2 — My Campaign (Assessment Task)

~20 min · Assessment

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Create a water safety message for other kids your age. Choose ONE:

Option A 📱

Design an Instagram post. Draw it or write what the picture and words would say.

Option B ✉️

Write a short letter to a Year 5 student about ONE water safety rule they should know.

Planning:

I chose Option: _____

My key message is: _____

One water safety fact I will use: _____

Where I found the fact (website): _____

My draft (write or draw here):

✏️ How Did I Go?

Circle: 😕 Not yet / 🙂 Getting there / 😊 I've got it!

I know what the red and yellow flags mean	😕	🙂	😊
I know how to escape a rip current	😕	🙂	😊
I know the DRS ABCD steps	😕	🙂	😊
I know all 5 SwimSafe rules	😕	🙂	😊
I know why rivers and dams are dangerous	😕	🙂	😊
I know Throw, Don't Go	😕	🙂	😊

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One thing I want to know more about:

Swim & Water Safety — Simplified Workbook · Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · HPE Year 7–8 · VC2HP8P08, VC2HP8P10

lsv.com.au · beachsafe.org.au · victoriancurriculum.vcaa.vic.edu.au

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